Assignment 1 Design Report

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1 Section 1: Case Study

1.1 Business Scenario: "Pulse: Operational Intelligence Platform for SMEs"

Small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) rarely have access to dedicated operational leadership. Business owners are left making critical decisions based on intuition rather than data, not because the data does not exist, but because synthesizing signals across financial systems, CRM platforms, and sales pipelines is too time-consuming to do consistently. The result is that operational problems (rising churn, deteriorating cash flow, stalling pipelines) are identified too late and acted on too slowly.

Pulse is an AI-powered Operational Intelligence Platform designed to fill this gap. Acting as a virtual Chief Operating Officer for SMEs, Pulse continuously ingests data from a company's core operational systems, computes key business metrics, detects anomalies and cross-functional patterns, and automatically generates narrative intelligence reports. Rather than functioning as a static dashboard, Pulse delivers actionable intelligence: it tells the SME owner not just what the numbers say, but what they mean and what to do about it.

The platform connects to two primary data source categories. The first is financial and accounting data, sourced from systems such as Exact Online and AFAS, covering revenue, expenses, cash flow, and outstanding invoices. The second is CRM and sales data, sourced from platforms such as HubSpot, covering pipeline value, conversion rates, churn, and new deals. Once ingested, data is normalized into a unified internal format, passed through a KPI calculation layer, and consumed by an AI agent layer that reasons across signals to produce structured, narrative intelligence reports. These reports are automatically delivered to the SME owner and relevant department heads on a scheduled cadence.

1.2 Stakeholders and Context Diagram

Pulse serves four categories of external actors:

The **SME Owner / CEO** is the primary recipient of Pulse's intelligence. They receive full operational reports, act on recommendations, and represent the core user the platform is designed for.

Department Heads such as the head of sales or head of finance receive domain-specific report sections relevant to their area of responsibility. They interact with the platform as consumers of targeted intelligence rather than the full operational picture.

The **Pulse Platform Administrator** is an internal actor responsible for onboarding new SME clients, managing data source connectors, and maintaining platform health. This role justifies the Tenant Management domain.

External Systems such as Exact Online, AFAS, and HubSpot are the data providers. They do not interact with Pulse directly as users but represent the system boundary through which operational data enters the platform. We refer to Figure 1

1.3 High-Level Functional Requirements

The platform must support the following high-level capabilities:

Data ingestion and normalization. Pulse must connect to external financial and CRM systems, retrieve operational data on a scheduled basis, and normalize it into a unified internal format for downstream processing.

KPI computation. The platform must compute a defined set of business metrics, including revenue growth, burn rate, cash flow position, pipeline conversion rate, and churn rate, from the normalized data and maintain a historical record of these metrics over time.

Operational intelligence generation. An AI agent layer must analyze computed KPIs, detect anomalies and trends, reason across signals from different operational domains, and generate natural language insights with actionable recommendations.

Report composition and delivery. Insights must be composed into structured, readable reports and automatically delivered to the SME owner and relevant department heads according to a configured schedule.

Tenant and user management. The platform must support onboarding of SME clients, management of user accounts and roles, and configuration of data source connections per tenant.

Event-driven notifications. The platform must send lightweight alerts for operationally significant events, such as critical anomaly detection, report delivery confirmation, or data connector failures.

1.4 Domain Overview

Applying Domain-Driven Design to the functional requirements above, six domains are identified. These are explored in detail in Section 2.

Data Integration, KPI & Analytics, and Reporting & Delivery could all exist in any BI tool. What makes Pulse unique and differentiated is the reasoning layer that connects signals, understands context, and tells you what to do. We refer to Figure 2

- **Operational Intelligence** (core): the AI agent reasoning layer
- **Data Integration** (supporting): external data ingestion and normalization
- **KPI & Analytics** (core / supporting): metric computation and historical storage
- **Reporting & Delivery** (core / supporting): report composition and scheduled delivery
- **Tenant Management** (generic): SME onboarding, user accounts, configuration
- **Notification** (generic): event-driven alerting

2 Identification of Business/Data Domains and Services/Agents/Data Products

2.1 Operational Intelligence

Operational Intelligence
The Operational Intelligence domain is the core differentiating capability of Pulse. It owns the full agentic reasoning pipeline: retrieving pre-computed KPI metrics and historical trend data from the KPI & Analytics data product's analytical store as a downstream consumer, coordinating a set of specialised reasoning agents, and producing structured insight payloads containing anomaly detections, trend analyses, and actionable recommendations. The domain is triggered on a configured schedule, ensuring autonomous and predictable operation aligned with the platform's weekly reporting cadence. It explicitly does not compute KPIs, ingest or transform data, or compose and deliver reports, those responsibilities belong to the KPI & Analytics, Data Integration, and Reporting & Delivery domains respectively. By consuming

only clean, pre-computed KPI summaries and trend data as input, the domain can focus entirely on reasoning logic without any data preparation concerns.

Features

- Retrieve the latest KPI metrics and historical trend data from the KPI & Analytics data product on a scheduled basis and initiate the agent reasoning workflow
- Analyse financial KPIs to detect anomalies such as abnormal burn rate increases, cash flow deterioration, or revenue decline against historical baselines
- Analyse sales and CRM KPIs to identify pipeline stagnation, declining conversion rates, and early customer churn signals
- Correlate signals across financial and sales domains to surface compound operational risks that neither domain-specific agent could detect in isolation
- Generate natural language insights with prioritised, actionable recommendations for each detected signal
- Produce a structured insight payload (tagged with domain, severity, narrative, and recommendations) for handoff to the Reporting & Delivery domain

Agents

Orchestrator Agent

The Orchestrator Agent manages the full reasoning workflow. It is triggered on a configured schedule, queries the KPI & Analytics data product's analytical store to retrieve the latest KPI metrics and trend data, and dispatches the Financial Intelligence Agent and the Sales & CRM Intelligence Agent in parallel via the A2A protocol. Once their outputs are available, it sequences the Cross-Domain Reasoning Agent and finally the Insight Synthesis Agent. Design principles:

- coarse granularity, as it governs the complete workflow lifecycle;
- autonomy, as it operates independently on a schedule without requiring external triggering;
- observability, as it maintains a reasoning trace log across the full run to support monitoring and debugging.

Financial Intelligence Agent

The Financial Intelligence Agent receives financial KPI metrics and historical trend data and applies LLM-driven reasoning to detect anomalies, evaluate trends, and generate financial-domain insights with accompanying recommendations. Design principles:

- high cohesion, as it is scoped exclusively to financial signal analysis;
- autonomy, as it operates with its own LLM context and reasoning prompt, independent of other agents.

Sales & CRM Intelligence Agent

The Sales & CRM Intelligence Agent receives sales and CRM KPI metrics and reasons over pipeline health, conversion trends, deal velocity, and churn indicators to produce sales-domain insights. Design principles:

- high cohesion, scoped exclusively to sales and CRM signal analysis;

- autonomy, operating independently with its own LLM context in parallel with the Financial Intelligence Agent.

Cross-Domain Reasoning Agent

The Cross-Domain Reasoning Agent receives the structured outputs of the Financial and Sales & CRM agents and reasons across them to identify compound operational risks, patterns that emerge only when signals from both domains are considered together, such as simultaneous revenue decline and accelerating churn pointing to a systemic business threat. Design principles:

- loose coupling, as it depends only on the structured output messages of the preceding agents and not on raw data or domain internals;
- fine granularity, as its sole responsibility is cross-signal correlation.

Insight Synthesis Agent

The Insight Synthesis Agent collects all agent outputs and assembles them into a single normalised insight payload, where each insight is structured with a domain tag, severity level, natural language narrative, and prioritised recommendations. This payload is the domain's output contract with the Reporting & Delivery domain. Design principles:

- statelessness, as each synthesis run is fully self-contained and produces a reproducible output regardless of prior runs;
- high cohesion, focused solely on structuring and packaging the reasoning outputs.

Design principles summary

The Operational Intelligence domain is designed as a multi-agent system where each agent encapsulates a single, well-defined reasoning responsibility, resulting in high cohesion within agents and loose coupling between them. Agent-to-agent communication via the A2A protocol ensures that agents remain interoperable and independently evolvable without direct dependencies on each other's internals. The Orchestrator Agent applies the coarse granularity principle to govern the full workflow, while domain-specific and cross-domain agents apply fine granularity to keep reasoning concerns clearly separated. Statelessness in the Insight Synthesis Agent guarantees that downstream domains receive consistent and reproducible outputs. Taken together, these principles make the reasoning pipeline modular, observable, and resilient to changes in individual agent logic or LLM behaviour. See the figure for this domain: Figure 3

2.2 Data Integration

Bounded context description: The data integration domain is responsible for ingesting, standardizing, and storing operational data from external systems such as financial platforms and CRM tools. It owns the full data ingestion pipeline, including API connectivity, data retrieval, validation, transformation into a unified schema, and persistence of both raw and normalized datasets. The domain ensures that heterogeneous data from multiple sources is made consistent and usable for downstream domains.

The data integration domain does not compute business metrics, detect patterns, anomalies or generate insights. It also does not perform domain-level business logic or analytical reasoning. Its responsibility is limited to syntactic transformation and reliable data provisioning, acting as a data plumber layer between external systems and internal analytic components.

Features:

- Fetch financial transaction data from external financial systems APIs (e.g., Exact Online, AFAS)
- Retrieve CRM data such as deals, pipeline status, and customer information from CRM platforms (e.g., HubSpot)
- Validate incoming data against predefined schema constraints and data quality rules
- Map source-specific data fields to a unified internal schema
- Transform heterogeneous data into a standardized and consistent format
- Persist both raw ingested data and normalized datasets for downstream consumption
- Execute scheduled batch ingestion and transformation pipelines (e.g., weekly updates)

Services / Agents / Data Products

- **Connector Service:** Handles connectivity with external systems and retrieves data via APIs on a scheduled or triggered basis.
  - Design principles: Loose coupling and reusability, as connectors are isolated per source system and can be extended independently.
- **Schema Mapping Service:** Maps source-specific data structures (e.g., financial records, CRM fields) into a unified internal schema.
  - Design principles: High cohesion and abstraction, as it encapsulates all schema transformation logic in one place.
- **Data Validation Service:** Validates incoming data against schema definitions and quality constraints before further processing.
  - Design principles: Autonomy and reliability, ensuring data correctness without relying on downstream domains.
- **Normalization Service:** Transforms validated data into a standardized format, resolving inconsistencies in structure, naming, and representation.
  - Design principles: High cohesion and consistency, as all transformation logic is centralized and deterministic.
- **Data Storage Service:** Persists both raw and normalized datasets in appropriate storage systems for traceability and downstream access.
  - Design principles: Separation of concerns and scalability, allowing storage mechanisms to evolve independently.

Design principles summary:
The Data Integration domain is designed around strong separation of concerns and high cohesion, where each service performs a clearly defined step in the ingestion pipeline. Loose coupling between services enables independent evolution of connectors, transformation logic, and storage mechanisms, which is essential when integrating multiple heterogeneous external systems. The domain is intentionally stateless in its processing steps, allowing scalable and repeatable batch execution. By strictly avoiding business logic and analytical reasoning, the domain maintains a clear boundary with downstream domains such as KPI & Analytics and Operational Intelligence, ensuring a modular and maintainable architecture.The Data Integration flow is intentionally shown at an abstract level. The normalization stage includes internal

validation, schema mapping, and transformation steps before the resulting data is persisted in the unified data store. See Figure 4

2.3 KPI & Analytics

The KPI & Analytics domain is designed as a data product that serves as the analytical engine of the platform. It is responsible for transforming normalized operational data into business metrics and maintaining the historical state for trend analysis. The domain owns its internal storage, computation logic, and its output interfaces. The domain responsibility is merely focused on the computation and storage of metrics. It does not interpret data, detect anomalies, or generate natural language insights; those responsibilities are done by the Operational Intelligence domain.

Features

- Compute financial metrics, e.g., monthly burn rate, revenue growth, cash flow from normalized expense and income data.
- Compute sales and CRM metrics such as conversion rates, deal velocity, and customer churn rates.
- Store and version the calculated metrics over time to maintain historical records for trend analysis.
- Structure the pre-computed metrics into a "Gold Layer" organized by domain (Financial vs. Sales/CRM) for retrieval.
- Expose data serving interface for downstream consumers, specifically the Operational Intelligence Orchestrator Agent.

Services / Agents / Data Products

- **KPI Computation Service: Calculates the business metrics from normalized data inputs.**
  - **Design Principles: High cohesion and statelessness, the service is focused solely on the metric calculation, and each run is deterministic, relying only on the input data for that period.**
- **Historical Storage Service: Manages the persistence and versioning of metrics to ensure a reliable data source for historical trends.**
  - **Design Principles: Autonomy and observability, the service owns its own database, preventing other domains from accessing it. Additionally, it implements observability by tracking data lineage to ensure traceable metrics.**
- **Data Serving Layer: Exposes the pre-computed tables to downstream domains through a standardized interface.**
  - **Design Principles: Discoverability and loose coupling, the interface is clearly defined so that the Operational Intelligence Orchestrator can query relevant metrics. This also allows the internal storage schema to be changed without breaking downstream agents.**

Design Principles Summary

The KPI & Analytics domain functions as a data product by owning the lifecycle of a business metric from calculation to storage and serving. High cohesion is maintained by separating calculation from storage management, and autonomy is ensured through the domain's ownership of its data state. By exposing a clearly defined serving interface, the domain maintains loose coupling with the Operational Intelligence layer so that metric calculations and internal data structures can evolve independently. For the architecture design for this domain see Figure 5

2.4 Reporting & Delivery

Bounded context description: The Reporting & Delivery domain is responsible for composing, formatting, and distributing reports based on the outputs from the Operational Intelligence domain. It owns report templates, composition logic, stakeholder-specific report structures, delivery schedules, and recipient configurations. The domain takes analyzed insights as input and transforms them into readable and well-structured reports, such as PDF documents and summarized email notifications, ensuring that stakeholders receive clear and actionable information in a consistent format.

The Reporting & Delivery domain does not compute KPIs, perform data ingestion or transformation, or reason across signals. It does not generate or interpret business insights, as this is the responsibility of the KPI & Analytics and Operational Intelligence domains. Instead, it focuses solely on presentation, assemble, scheduling, and delivery of already generated insights, maintaining a clear boundary between intelligence generation and information communication.

2.4.1 Features:

- Assemble report sections into a tenant-specific report based on predefined templates
- Structure and format insights into readable sections, tables, and summaries
- Generate report outputs in standardized formats (e.g. PDF and email summaries)
- Schedule report generation and delivery based on configured intervals (e.g. weekly)
- Deliver reports to configured stakeholders (e.g. SME owner and department heads)
- Manage report distribution settings, including recipients and delivery channels

Services / Agents / Data Products

- **Composition Service: Assembles report sections by combining insights from the Operational Intelligence domain into a structured, tenant-specific report.**
  - **Design principles: High cohesion and separation of concerns, as it focus solely on assembling a report content without handling formatting or delivery**
- **Template Service: Applies predefined report templates to structure insights into consistent layouts and sections for each tenant.**
  - **Design principles: Abstraction and reusability, as templates standardize report structure across tenants while allowing configuration.**
- **Scheduling Service: Triggers report generation and delivery based on configured intervals (e.g. weekly schedules).**

  - **Design principles: Autonomy and statelessness, enabling independent and repeatable scheduling without dependency on other services.**

- **Delivery Service: Distributes generated reports to stakeholders via configured channels (e.g. email with PDF attachments and summary messages).**
  - **Design principles: Loose coupling and scalability, as delivery mechanisms are decoupled from report generation and can evolve independently**

Design principles summary
The Reporting & Delivery domain is designed with strong separation of concerns, where composition, templating, scheduling, and delivery are handled by distinct services. High cohesion ensures that each service focuses on a single responsibility, while loose coupling allows independent evolution of report generation and delivery mechanisms. The domain operates in a stateless and configurable manner, supporting scalable and repeatable report generation. By avoiding analytical logic and relying on upstream domains for insights, it maintains a clear boundary between intelligence generation and information presentation. And i refer to the diagram which has been made for this domain Figure 6

2.5 Tenant Management

Bounded context description: The Tenant Management domain is responsible for onboarding SME clients, managing tenant-specific configuration, and controlling user access within the Pulse platform. It owns tenant registration, user accounts, role assignments, connector configuration metadata, and the isolation of tenant-level settings required by other domains. This domain ensures that each SME operates within its own bounded operational space, with the correct users, permissions, and data source configuration in place before any ingestion, analytics, or reporting can occur. The domain does not ingest external business data, compute KPIs, generate operational insights, or deliver reports. Its responsibility is purely administrative and configurational, which makes its boundary clear and defensible within the overall architecture.

Features:

- Register a new SME tenant and initialize its platform workspace
- Create, update, and deactivate tenant-specific user accounts
- Assign and manage user roles such as SME Owner, Department Head, and Platform Administrator
- Store and manage connector configuration metadata per tenant for systems such as Exact, AFAS, and HubSpot
- Enforce tenant isolation for users, settings, and downstream service access
- Maintain tenant lifecycle state, for example active, suspended, or offboarded

Services / Agents / Data Products

- Tenant Onboarding Service: Creates a new tenant, initializes the tenant workspace, and registers the baseline configuration required for platform usage.
  Design principles: high cohesion, because it focuses solely on tenant creation and initialization; separation of concerns, because onboarding logic is isolated from authentication, analytics, and connector execution.

- User and Role Management Service: Manages user accounts within each tenant and assigns the correct access roles based on stakeholder responsibilities.
  Design principles: high cohesion, because all identity and authorization administration is centralized here; loose coupling, because downstream domains only consume role and tenant context rather than implementing their own user logic.
- Tenant Configuration Service: Stores and manages tenant-level settings such as connector metadata, report preferences, and domain-specific configuration references.
  Design principles: abstraction, because configuration is exposed through a clean internal interface rather than embedded across domains; reusability, because all other domains can rely on one consistent source of tenant configuration.
- Access Control Service: Enforces tenant boundaries and validates whether a given user or process may access a tenant's resources or configuration.
  Design principles: reliability, because correct access enforcement is essential for multi-tenant integrity; statelessness, because authorization checks should be repeatable and independent per request.

Design principles summary

The Tenant Management domain is intentionally designed as a thin generic domain that centralizes administrative responsibilities without absorbing business logic from other domains. High cohesion is achieved by grouping onboarding, user administration, configuration, and access control into clearly scoped services, while loose coupling ensures that downstream domains depend only on tenant context and permissions, not on internal management workflows. By keeping tenant state and configuration explicit, the architecture supports clean multi-tenant isolation and simpler operational governance. This makes the platform easier to scale across multiple SME clients while preserving a clear separation between administration and operational intelligence.

2.6 Notification

Bounded context description

The Notification domain is responsible for dispatching event-driven alerts to stakeholders and platform administrators through email, SMS, and Slack. It owns the routing logic that determines which channel to use for a given event, the formatting of alert messages per channel, and the reliable delivery of those messages. The domain is triggered by events emitted from other domains, primarily report delivery confirmations from Reporting & Delivery **and platform-level incidents such as connector failures from Data Integration. I**t does not generate insights, compose reports, or determine the business significance of events; it formats, routes, and delivers notification requests. Note: full report distribution (e.g., PDF attachments) is owned by the Reporting & Delivery domain. This domain handles lightweight alerting only, such as confirmations, warnings, and failure notices.

Features

- Receive notification trigger events from upstream domains via an internal event bus
- Route each notification to the appropriate channel (email, SMS, Slack) based on event type and recipient configuration
- Format alert messages per channel, respecting channel-specific constraints (character limits, block formatting)
- Dispatch notifications through external provider APIs like Slack Webhooks

- Track delivery status and emit confirmation or failure events for observability

Services

Notification Router Service Receives incoming notification events and determines the target channel(s) based on event type and recipient preferences. Design principles: loose coupling, as it depends only on a standardised event schema with no direct dependency on emitting domains; high cohesion, as it handles routing logic exclusively.

Message Formatting Service Transforms routed notification content into the appropriate channel format, which is short text for SMS, block message for Slack, templated HTML for email alerts. Design principles: reusability, as formatting templates are shared across event types which helps with high cohesion, as all channel-specific formatting is centralised here.

Dispatch Service Sends formatted messages to external channel providers and records delivery outcomes. Design principles: autonomy, as it manages its own retry logic independently of upstream services; observability, as it logs delivery status and emits confirmation or failure events for platform monitoring.

Design principles summary

The Notification domain is kept thin and generic. Loose coupling to upstream domains is achieved through a standardised event schema on the event bus, allowing any domain to trigger notifications without the Notification domain needing knowledge of the emitting context. Routing, formatting, and dispatch are separated into three cohesive services, meaning a new channel can be added by extending only the Formatting and Dispatch services. Statelessness in the router and formatter, combined with autonomous retry handling in the Dispatch Service, keeps the pipeline resilient and independently scalable

3 Architectural Design

4 Member Contribution and Reflection

4.1 Member Contribution

Thom Verzantvoort contributed to Section 1 (case study framing, stakeholder identification, and domain overview) and led Section 2 for the Operational Intelligence domain, including the multi-agent design and A2A protocol rationale.

Rick de Rijk contributed to Section 1 (functional requirements and context diagram) and led Section 2 for the Data Integration and Reporting & Delivery domains, covering the ingestion pipeline, composition, templating, scheduling, and delivery services.

Tycho van Rooij led Section 2 for the Notification domain, designing the event-driven alerting architecture including routing, formatting, and dispatch services.

Jelles Duin led Section 2 for the KPI & Analytics domain, designing the data product structure, computation services, historical storage, and the Gold Layer serving interface.

Gilbert Laanen led Section 2 for the Tenant Management domain, covering tenant onboarding, user and role management, configuration, and access control services.

4.2 Reflection

5 Technology Statement

During the preparation of this work, we used ChatGPT (GPT-4o) & Claude in order to support grammar and clarity checks, brainstorm initial platform concepts, and guide the domain design process through an interactive questioning approach, prompting us to reflect on design decisions and come up with our own ideas and solutions rather than generating content directly. The following parts of the assignment were affected by AI tool usage: Section 1 (brainstorming and grammar review), Section 2 (design guidance and grammar review), Section 3 (grammar review), and Section 4 (grammar review). After using this tool/service, Rick de Rijk, Thom Verzantvoort, Tycho van Rooij, Jelles Duin, and Gilbert Laanen evaluated the validity of the tool's outputs and edited the content as needed. As a consequence, Rick de Rijk, Thom Verzantvoort, Tycho van Rooij, Jelles Duin, and Gilbert Laanen take full responsibility for the content of this work.

6 References

7 Appendix

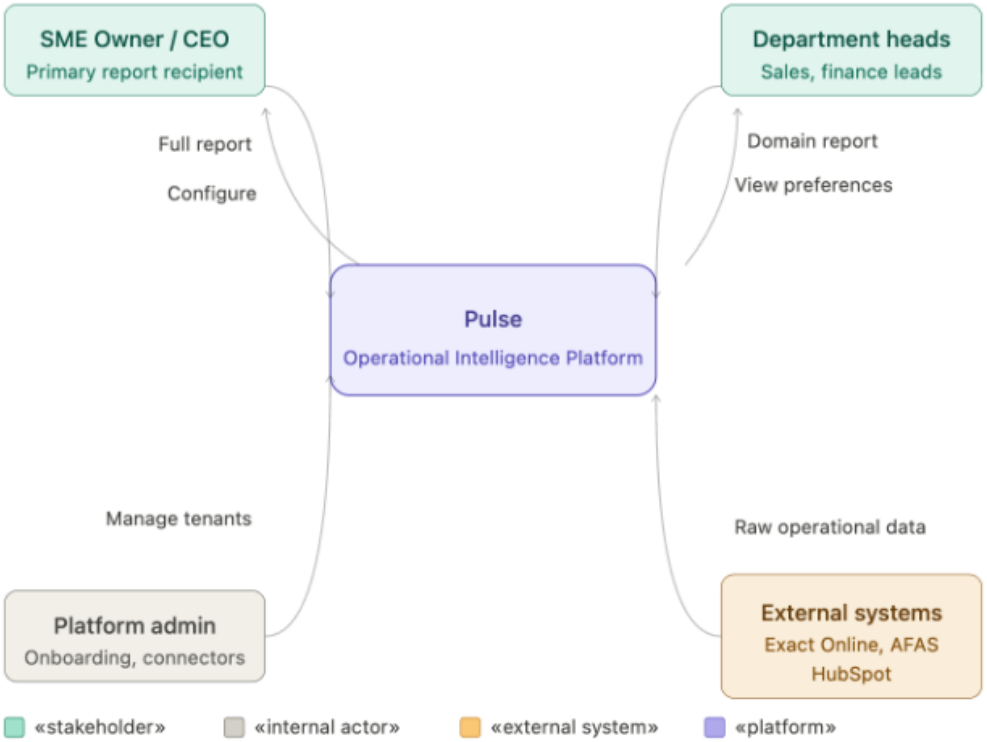

Figure 1 - **Context Diagram**

Figure 1: Context Diagram

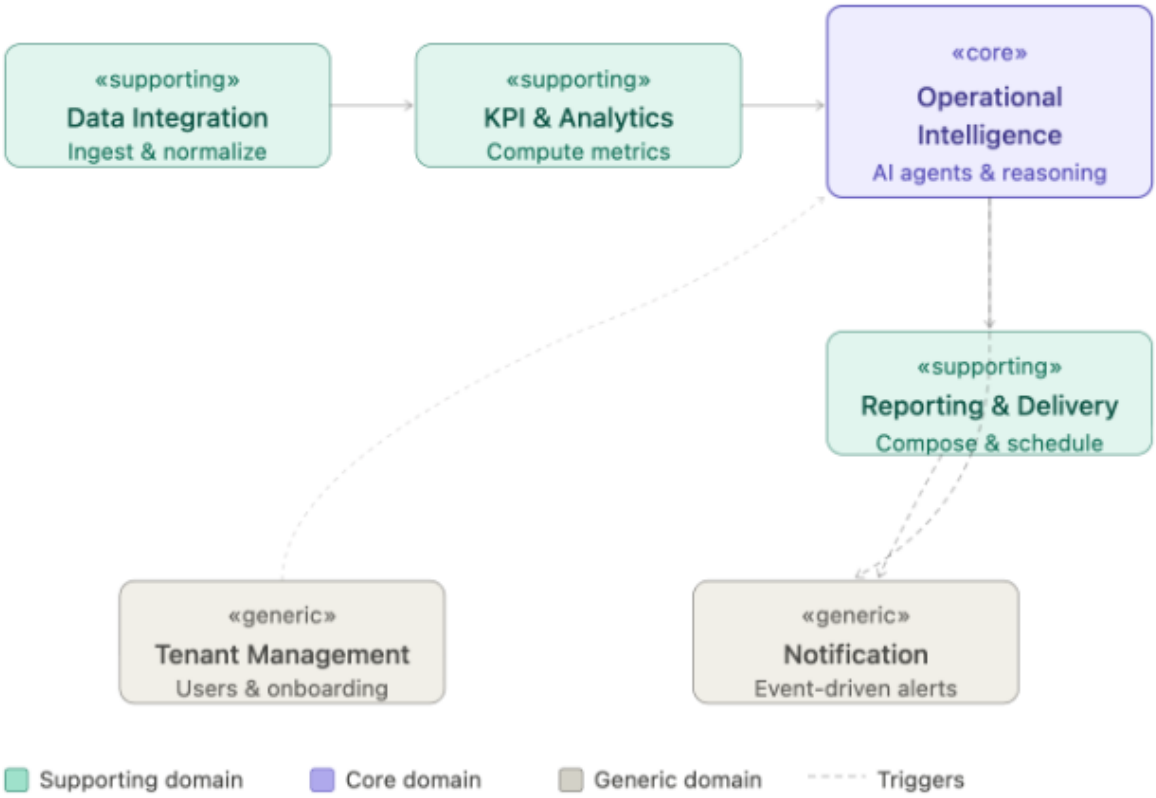

Figure 2: Domain Diagram

Figure 3: Operational Intelligence Domain

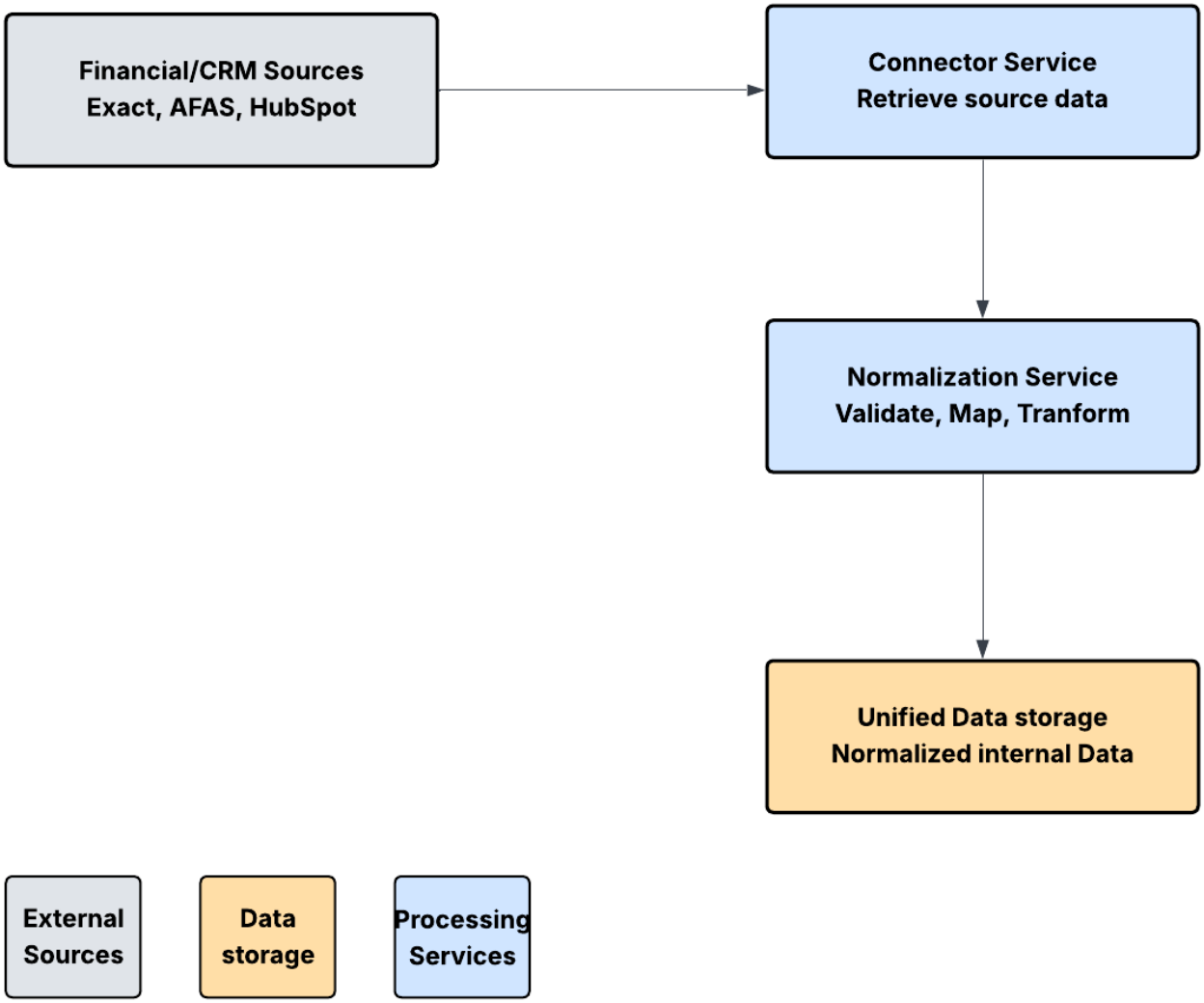

Figure 4: Data Integration Domain

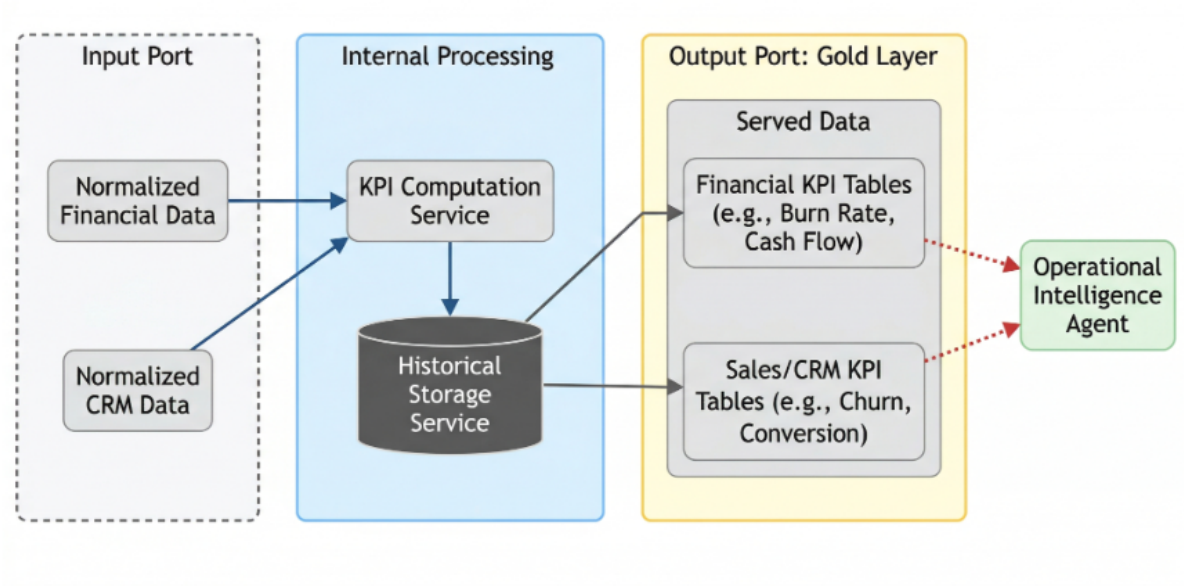

Figure 5: KPI-Domain

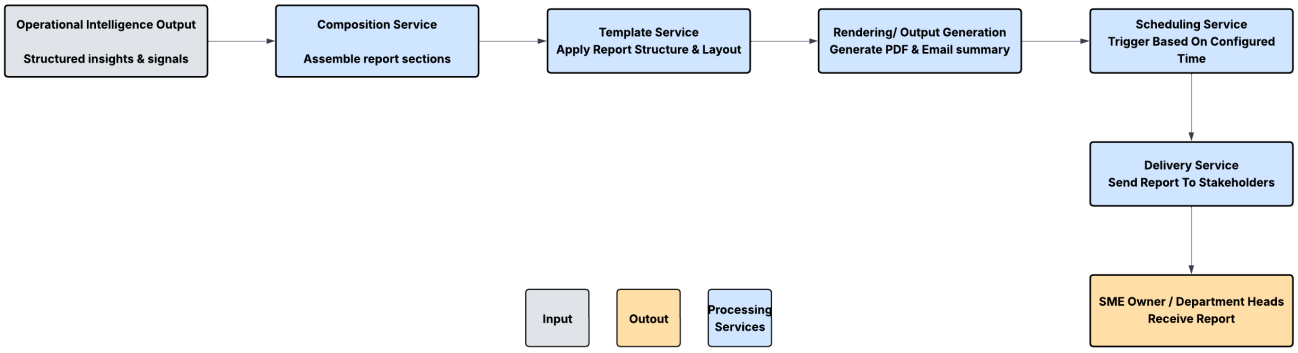

Figure 6: Domain-Report-Diagram